# STANDATA interpretation 23-BCI-014

Building

## Integrated testing coordinator

Date Issued: March 2025

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### Purpose

To clarify the expectation for qualifications of an “integrated testing coordinator.”

### Discussion

Where fire protection and life safety systems and systems with fire protection and life safety functions are integrated with each other, the National Building Code – 2023 Alberta Edition (NBC(AE)) prescribes the systems to be tested in accordance with CAN/ULC-S1001, “Standard for Integrated Systems Testing of Fire Protection and Life Safety Systems.”

CAN/ULC-S1001 requires the involvement of an “integrated testing coordinator,” and that the integrated testing coordinator be knowledgeable and experienced in the design, installation, and operation of fire protection and life safety system(s), and the fire protection and life safety functions of building systems.

The NBC(AE) also indicates that a “registered engineering professional” is required for certain aspects of design, which includes, but is not limited to, the following:

- fire alarm systems;
- projects where the size and complexity may give rise to special safety concerns;
- fire protection systems;
- mechanical life safety systems; and
- electrical life safety systems.



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## Code References

**Division A, Article 1.4.1.2.**

**1.4.1.2. Defined Terms**
*Registered engineering professional* means an individual who is authorized to engage in the practice of engineering under the Engineering and Geoscience Professions Act and its Regulations.

*Registered professional* means an individual who qualifies as a
(a) *registered architectural professional*,
(b) *registered engineering professional*, or
(c) *licensed interior designer*.

**Division C, Sentence 2.4.1.1.(4)**

**2.4.1.1. General**
4) If the size or complexity of a project may give rise to special safety concerns, the authority having jurisdiction may require the involvement of one or more registered professionals to authenticate all or part of the drawings and specifications and perform field reviews.

**Division C, Article 2.4.1.3.**

**2.4.1.3. Fire Suppression System Designs**
1) If an automatic fire suppression system is to be installed in a *building* described in Sentence 2.4.1.1.(3), the owner shall submit evidence to the *authority having jurisdiction*, before construction begins, that they have retained a *registered professional* to
a) design the system,
b) perform *field reviews* of the system during installation, and
c) witness the testing of the system after installation.

**Division C, Article 2.4.1.4.**

**2.4.1.4. Fire Alarm System Designs**
1) If a fire alarm system is to be installed in a *building* described in Sentence 2.4.1.1.(3), the owner shall submit evidence to the *authority having jurisdiction*, before construction begins, that they have retained a *registered professional* to
a) design the system,
b) perform *field reviews* of the system during installation, and
c) witness verification of the system after installation.

**Sentence 3.2.9.1.(1)**

**3.2.9.1. Testing**
1) Where fire protection and life safety systems and systems with fire protection and life safety functions are integrated with each other, they shall be tested as a whole in accordance with CAN/ULC-S1001, “Standard for Integrated Systems Testing of Fire Protection and Life Safety Systems,” to verify that they have been properly integrated. (See Note A-3.2.9.1.(1).)

**A-3.2.9.1.(1) Testing of Fire Protection and Life Safety Systems.** Building owners should verify that fire protection and life safety systems and their components (i.e. fire alarm systems, sprinklers, standpipes, smoke control, ventilation, pressurization, door hold-open devices, elevator recalls, smoke and fire shutters and dampers, emergency power, emergency lighting, fire pumps, generators, etc.),


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including their interconnections with other building systems, are functioning according to the intent of their design. CAN/ULC-S1001, “Standard for Integrated Systems Testing of Fire Protection and Life Safety Systems,” provides the methodology for verifying and documenting that interconnections between building systems satisfy the intent of their design and that the systems function as intended by the Code. Clause 6.1.5 of CAN/ULC-S1001 allows the integrated testing coordinator to accept documented evidence of any tests that have been performed on a system as part of its acceptance testing for the purpose of demonstrating compliance with the integrated testing requirements of that standard, so as to avoid duplication of work.

**Sentence 9.10.1.2.(1)**

**9.10.1.2. Testing of Integrated Fire Protection and Life Safety Systems**
1) Where life safety and fire protection systems and systems with fire protection and life safety functions are integrated with each other, they shall be tested as a whole in accordance with CAN/ULC-S1001, “Standard for Integrated Systems Testing of Fire Protection and Life Safety Systems,” to verify that they have been properly integrated. (See Note A-3.2.9.1.(1).)

**National Fire Code – 2023 Alberta Edition, Division C, Sentence 2.2.4.8.(1)**

**2.2.4.8. Integrated Fire Protection and Life Safety Systems**
**1)** A person qualified to be an integrated testing coordinator shall be a registered engineering professional knowledgeable and experienced in the design, installation and operation of fire protection and life safety systems and in the fire protection and life safety functions of *building* systems. (See Note A-2.2.4.8.(1).)

**A-2.2.4.8.(1)** A non-registered engineering professional may do the groundwork for the integrated systems testing, provided that the registered engineering professional supervises, approves and officially signs off on that work.

**CAN/ULC-S1001-11, Subsection 4.2**

**4.2 INTEGRATED TESTING COORDINATOR**

4.2.1 The integrated testing coordinator shall be knowledgeable and experienced in the design, installation, and operation of fire protection and life safety system(s), and the fire protection and life safety functions of building systems. Refer to Appendix A 4.2.1.

4.2.2 The integrated testing coordinator shall have knowledge and understanding of:

A The Codes and Standards that regulate the design and installation of fire protection and life safety system(s);

B How individual and integrated fire protection and life safety system(s) are designed to operate during normal operating conditions and emergency conditions; and

C Methods for validating the intended functionality of integrated fire protection and life safety system(s).

4.2.3 The integrated testing coordinator shall have all licenses and certification if required by:

A Federal, provincial, territorial or other applicable regulation; and/or

B Contractual obligations.



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## Application

This interpretation applies to individuals or corporations presenting themselves in the position of an “integrated testing coordinator” to perform the duties required in accordance with CAN/ULC-S1001, “Standard for Integrated Systems Testing of Fire Protection and Life Safety Systems.”

## Interpretation

An integrated testing coordinator is considered to be a registered engineering professional who is knowledgeable and experienced in the design, installation, and operation of fire protection and life safety system(s), and the fire protection and life safety functions of building systems.

This INTERPRETATION is applicable throughout the Province of Alberta.

Unless stated otherwise, all Code references in this STANDATA are to Division B of the National Building Code – 2023 Alberta Edition

Issued by the Provincial Building Administrator

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